

✳ **Idiomatic Sequences in Narrative Passages:**

→ Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank.

1. Rohan had always dreamed of running his own restaurant, but when his savings ran out and the bank rejected his loan, he realized his ambitious plan had _____.
 - a. hit the nail on the head
 - b. gone up in smoke
 - c. come rain or shine
 - d. turned over a new leaf
2. The two rival companies had been suing each other for years, but when a mutual client threatened to leave both of them, they finally decided to _____ and collaborate.
 - a. spill the beans
 - b. jump ship
 - c. bury the hatchet
 - d. cut corners
3. Meera had rehearsed her presentation for weeks, but the moment she stood before the panel, her mind went blank and she completely _____.
 - a. went the extra mile
 - b. hit the ground running
 - c. let the cat out of the bag
 - d. drew a blank
4. The startup's founders knew that entering an already saturated market was risky, but they decided to _____ and launch anyway.
 - a. throw in the towel
 - b. beat around the bush
 - c. take the plunge
 - d. call it a day
5. After the scandal broke, the minister tried to _____ his involvement, but journalists had already found the evidence.
 - a. beef up
 - b. play down
 - c. rev up
 - d. light up
6. The negotiations had stalled for months until the new CEO stepped in and managed to _____, securing a deal within a week.
 - a. jump the gun
 - b. rock the boat
 - c. miss the boat
 - d. break the deadlock
7. Vikram knew the project timeline was unrealistic, but rather than raise concerns, he decided to _____, hoping things would somehow work out.
 - a. let sleeping dogs lie
 - b. burn his bridges
 - c. go the extra mile
 - d. sit on the fence

8. The company had been losing money for three years, and rather than continuing to invest, the board finally decided to _____.
 - a. foot the bill
 - b. cut their losses
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 - d. foot the mould
9. Ananya's boss praised her work in front of everyone but privately criticised every small mistake – a classic case of _____.
 - a. crying wolf
 - b. barking up the wrong tree
 - c. blowing hot and cold
 - d. reading between the lines
10. The two committee members disagreed on almost everything, but when it came to the budget cuts, they were finally _____.
 - a. out of the blue
 - b. on the same page
 - c. beating around the bush
 - d. once in a blue moon

✳ **Idiom Usage & Contextual Meaning:**

→ Choose the sentence in which the given idiom has been used appropriately.

1. Idiom: "spill the beans"
 - a. She spilled the beans on the table while cooking dinner.
 - b. He accidentally spilled the beans about the surprise party.
 - c. The manager spilled the beans over the new project to avoid delays.
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2. Idiom: "burn the midnight oil"
 - a. The candle burned the midnight oil all through the night.
 - b. He burned the midnight oil in the fireplace to keep warm.
 - c. They burned midnight oils preparing dinner for the guests.
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 - a. The gift was wrapped as a blessing in disguise for her birthday.
 - b. Losing that hectic job turned out to be a blessing in disguise, as it pushed him to start his own business.
 - c. He wore a blessing in disguise costume for the party.
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 - a. The moon turns once in a blue moon during eclipses.
 - b. She eats junk food once in a blue moon meal every day.
 - c. My grandfather visits the city once in a blue moon.
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5. Idiom: "the last straw"
 - a. She drank the last straw of juice from the glass.
 - b. The last straw fell from the roof during the storm.
 - c. He picked the last straw to build the nest.
 - d. Missing the client meeting was the last straw.
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 - a. She cut the corners of the paper to make it fit the frame.
 - b. The contractor cut corners on safety measures.
 - c. He cut corners around the block while driving home.
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 - a. The teacher asked students to read between the lines of the poem aloud.
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 - d. He read between the lines while proofreading the manuscript for typos.
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 - a. The boxer threw in the towel from the ring after winning the match.
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 - a. He hit the nail on the head with a hammer while fixing the shelf.
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10. Idiom: "jump on the bandwagon"
 - a. The children jumped on the bandwagon during the parade to get a better view.
 - b. He jumped on the bandwagon of hay stacked near the barn.
 - c. She jumped onto the bandwagon wheel while helping load the truck.
 - d. Many investors jumped on the bandwagon without understanding the risks.

✱ **Sequence-Based Idiomatic Fit:**

- Match the idioms with their meanings, then select the option that gives the correct sequence for meanings 1–2–3–4.
1. Match the idioms with their meanings:
 - A. Burn the midnight oil
 - B. Bite the bullet
 - C. Add fuel to the fire
 - D. Beat around the bush
1. Avoid speaking directly about a topic
 2. Face a difficult situation bravely
 3. Worsen an already bad situation

4. Work late into the night

Options

- a. 1D-2B-3C-4A
- b. 1B-2D-3A-4C
- c. 1A-2C-3D-4B
- d. 1C-2A-3B-4D

2. Match the idioms with their meanings:

- A. Costs an arm and a leg
- B. A piece of cake
- C. Under the weather
- D. On thin ice

- 1. Feeling slightly ill
- 2. Very expensive
- 3. In a risky situation
- 4. Very easy

Options

- a. 1A-2B-3C-4D
- b. 1C-2A-3D-4B
- c. 1D-2C-3B-4A
- d. 1B-2D-3A-4C

3. Match the idioms with their meanings:

- A. Kick the bucket
- B. Hit the sack
- C. Break the ice
- D. Call it a day

- 1. Ease tension in a social setting
- 2. Stop working for the day
- 3. Go to bed
- 4. To die

Options

- a. 1A-2B-3C-4D
- b. 1B-2A-3D-4C
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- d. 1D-2C-3A-4B

4. Match the idioms with their meanings:

- A. Steal someone's thunder
- B. Go back to the drawing board
- C. Miss the boat
- D. Pull someone's leg

- 1. Joke with someone
- 2. Lose an opportunity

3. Take credit for someone else's achievement

4. Start planning again from scratch

Options

a. 1A-2B-3C-4D

b. 1B-2A-3D-4C

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d. 1D-2C-3A-4B

5. Match the idioms with their meanings:

A. Bark up the wrong tree

B. Get cold feet

C. Have a chip on one's shoulder

D. Cross that bridge when you come to it

1. Become nervous before doing something

2. Deal with a problem when it arises

3. Pursue a mistaken course of action

4. Hold a grudge / feel resentful

Options for sequence (1-2-3-4):

a. 1B-2D-3A-4C

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6. Match the idioms with their meanings:

A. Give someone the benefit of the doubt

B. Cut to the chase

C. Go the extra mile

D. Let the chips fall where they may

1. Make more effort than expected

2. Get to the point quickly

3. Accept the outcome without controlling it

4. Believe someone despite uncertainty

Options

a. 1A-2B-3C-4D

b. 1D-2A-3B-4C

c. 1B-2C-3A-4D

d. 1C-2B-3D-4A

7. Match the idioms with their meanings:

A. Rock the boat

B. Sit on the fence

C. Turn a blind eye

D. Keep someone at arm's length

1. Deliberately ignore something
2. Maintain distance in a relationship
3. Disturb a stable situation
4. Avoid taking sides

Options

- a. 1A-2C-3B-4D
- b. 1C-2D-3A-4B
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8. Match the idioms with their meanings:

- A. Jump the gun
- B. Go down in flames
- C. Play devil's advocate
- D. Take with a pinch of salt

1. Argue the opposite side for debate's sake
2. Fail spectacularly
3. Regard something with skepticism
4. Act before the right time

Options

- a. 1A-2D-3B-4C
- b. 1D-2C-3A-4B
- c. 1B-2A-3C-4D
- d. 1C-2B-3D-4A

9. Match the idioms with their meanings:

- A. Put all your eggs in one basket
- B. Back to square one
- C. Face the music
- D. Keep your chin up

1. Start over from the beginning
2. Accept the consequences of one's actions
3. Stay positive during difficulty
4. Risk everything on a single plan

Options

- a. 1D-2A-3B-4C
- b. 1A-2B-3C-4D
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10. Match the idioms with their meanings:

- A. Not see the forest for the trees
- B. Come full circle
- C. Draw a line in the sand
- D. Give someone a run for their money

1. Set a firm limit
2. Return to the original position or situation
3. Provide strong competition
4. Miss the big picture due to small details

Options

- a. 1A-2D-3B-4C
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b. gone up in smoke
c. come rain or shine
d. turned over a new leaf

Answer: b. gone up in smoke

2. The two rival companies had been suing each other for years, but when a mutual client threatened to leave both of them, they finally decided to _____ and collaborate.
a. spill the beans
b. jump ship
c. bury the hatchet
d. cut corners

Answer: c. bury the hatchet

3. Meera had rehearsed her presentation for weeks, but the moment she stood before the panel, her mind went blank and she completely _____.
a. went the extra mile
b. hit the ground running
c. let the cat out of the bag
d. drew a blank

Answer: d. drew a blank

4. The startup's founders knew that entering an already saturated market was risky, but they decided to _____ and launch anyway.
a. throw in the towel
b. beat around the bush
c. take the plunge
d. call it a day

Answer: c. take the plunge

5. After the scandal broke, the minister tried to _____ his involvement, but journalists had already found the evidence.
a. beef up
b. play down
c. rev up
d. light up

Answer: b. play down

6. The negotiations had stalled for months until the new CEO stepped in and managed to _____, securing a deal within a week.
a. jump the gun
b. rock the boat

- c. miss the boat
- d. break the deadlock

Answer: d. break the deadlock

7. Vikram knew the project timeline was unrealistic, but rather than raise concerns, he decided to _____, hoping things would somehow work out.
- a. let sleeping dogs lie
 - b. burn his bridges
 - c. go the extra mile
 - d. sit on the fence

Answer: a. let sleeping dogs lie

8. The company had been losing money for three years, and rather than continuing to invest, the board finally decided to _____.
- a. foot the bill
 - b. cut their losses
 - c. turn the tables
 - d. foot the mould

Answer: b. cut their losses

9. Ananya's boss praised her work in front of everyone but privately criticised every small mistake – a classic case of _____.
- a. crying wolf
 - b. barking up the wrong tree
 - c. blowing hot and cold
 - d. reading between the lines

Answer: c. blowing hot and cold

10. The two committee members disagreed on almost everything, but when it came to the budget cuts, they were finally _____.
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 - b. on the same page
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Answer: b. on the same page

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 - c. The manager spilled the beans over the new project to avoid delays.
 - d. He spilled the bean about his plans to no one in particular.

Answer: b. He accidentally spilled the beans about the surprise party.

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 - a. The candle burned the midnight oil all through the night.
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Answer: d. She burned the midnight oil to finish her assignment on time.
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 - a. The gift was wrapped as a blessing in disguise for her birthday.
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 - c. He wore a blessing in disguise costume for the party.
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Answer: b. Losing that hectic job turned out to be a blessing in disguise.
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Answer: c. My grandfather visits the city once in a blue moon.
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Answer: d. Missing the client meeting was the last straw.
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Answer: b. The contractor cut corners on safety measures.
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Answer: d. The founders finally threw in the towel and shut down the startup.

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- a. He hit the nail on the head with a hammer while fixing the shelf.
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Answer: b. Her argument hit the nail on the head.

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Options for sequence (1-2-3-4):

- a. 1D-2B-3C-4A
- b. 1B-2D-3A-4C
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Answer: a. 1D-2B-3C-4A

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Answer: d. 1C-2B-3D-4A